

Paragraph / section function - Workbook 3

Focused practice - Workbook 3 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Transit Survey

A report claims that riders value reliability more than onboard Wi-Fi. One paragraph presents survey results: 72 percent ranked on-time service among their top two priorities, compared with 18 percent for Wi-Fi.

1. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. provides evidence for the report's claim about rider priorities
- B. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- C. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

2. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. The percentages support the claim with direct survey data.
- C. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- D. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.

Community Kitchen

An article describes a community kitchen that offers low-cost cooking classes. After several positive participant comments, one paragraph explains that the program still has a six-week waiting list and limited evening space.

3. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- B. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- C. introduces a limitation after describing benefits
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

4. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- C. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.
- D. It prevents the article from presenting the program as fully accessible to everyone who wants to join.

Harbor Forecast

A weather explainer defines storm surge and describes how wind can push seawater toward shore. The final section tells readers where to find local evacuation maps and when officials may issue a surge warning.

5. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. shifts from explanation to practical action for readers
- B. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- C. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

6. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. It turns scientific background into guidance readers can use during a warning.
- C. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- D. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. The percentages support the claim with direct survey data.
2. B. The percentages support the claim with direct survey data.
3. C. It prevents the article from presenting the program as fully accessible to everyone who wants to join.
4. D. It prevents the article from presenting the program as fully accessible to everyone who wants to join.
5. A. It turns scientific background into guidance readers can use during a warning.
6. B. It turns scientific background into guidance readers can use during a warning.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.